

March 8, 2026

The Governor of Alabama
Alabama State Capitol
600 Dexter Avenue
Montgomery, AL 36130

Dear Governor Ivey,

We are writing to ask you to grant clemency to Mark Jenkins. We have prayed for mercy for Mark, and we hope that you will grant this mercy by commuting his sentence from death to life in prison without the possibility of parole.

We are three correctional officers who know Mark well and support him deeply. We have, collectively, spent many decades working on death row at Holman Correctional Facility in Atmore, Alabama. And we are not alone; over sixty correctional officers support clemency for Mark.

None of us has written or signed onto a letter supporting clemency for a death row inmate before. We do not take this request for mercy lightly. Mark was convicted of killing an innocent person and must be punished. But we have gotten to know Mark and have watched him grow. He is kind, respectful, and peaceful. He embodies the transformative power of God's grace. Having interacted with hundreds of death row inmates, we know that Mark is not just special. He is one of a kind. We strongly believe that Mark should not be put to death.

Mark has worked hard to develop as a person and to help around Holman in any way he can. He worked as a hall runner, a role reserved for trusted inmates, and helped the correctional officers with simple tasks. Mark is mentally limited, but he has still been a reliable worker, following orders and consistently treating others with politeness and warmth. He does his best to make Holman a better, safer place.

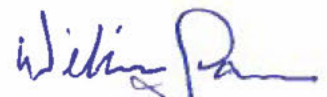
Mark has also worked to repent. Through accepting Jesus Christ as his Savior, Mark has tried to grapple with the harm he caused and has done his best to be a model inmate. He showed profound and genuine remorse after his crime, a remorse we believe he continues to feel deeply over thirty-six years later. Although Mark's shame has made it difficult for him to speak about his crime, he has never made excuses or asked for pity.

We are not asking that you let Mark off the hook. Mark should, without a doubt, remain in prison for the rest of his life. A sentence of life without the possibility of parole, while merciful, is not lenient. It is a lifelong punishment, and a harsh one. It is the appropriate punishment in this case. Only you have the power to commute Mark's sentence from death to life in prison without the possibility of parole. We pray that you use that power to grant Mark clemency.

"He saved us, not because of righteous things we had done, but because of His mercy."

— Titus 3:5

Sincerely,



Sgt. William James